Angular NgClass Directive

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The **Angular ngClass** Directive is an Angular Attribute Directive, which allows us to add or remove CSS classes to an HTML element. Using `ngClass` you can create dynamic styles in angular components by using conditional expressions.

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NgClass

The `ngClass` directive adds and removes CSS classes on an HTML element. The syntax of the `ngClass` is as shown below.

```

<element [ngClass]="expression">...</element>

```

Where

element is the DOM element to which class is being applied

expression is evaluated and the resulting classes are added/removed from the element. The `expression` can be in various formats like string, array or an object. Let us explore all of them with example

NgClass with a String

You can use the String as expression and bind it to directly to the `ngClass` attribute. If you want to assign multiple classes, then separate each class with space as shown below.

```

<element [ngClass]="'cssClass1 cssClass2'">...</element>

```

Example

Add the following classes to the `app.component.css`

```

.red { color: red; }
.size20 { font-size: 20px; }

```

Add the following to the `app.template.html`

```

<div [ngClass]="'red size20'"> Red Text with Size 20px </div>

```

The above example code adds the two CSS Classes `red` & `size20` to the `div` element.

> You can also use the `ngClass` without a square bracket. In that case, the expression is not evaluated but assigned directly to the class attribute. We also need to remove the double quote around the expression as shown below.

```

<div class="row">
    <div ngClass='red size20'>Red Text with Size 20px </div>
</div>

```

NgClass with Array

You can achieve the same result by using an array instead of a string as shown below. The syntax for `ngClass` array syntax is as shown below

```

<element [ngClass]="['cssClass1', 'cssClass2']">...</element>

```

Example

All you need to change the template as shown below

```

<div [ngClass]="['red','size20']">Red Text with Size 20px </div>

```

NgClass with Object

You can also bind the `ngClass` to an object. Each property name of the object acts as a class name and is applied to the element if it is true. The syntax is as shown below

```

<element [ngClass]="{'cssClass1': true, 'cssClass2': true}">...</element>

```

Example of objects as CSS Classes

```

<div class="row">
  <div [ngClass]="{'red':true,'size20':true}">Red Text with Size 20px</div>
</div>

```

In the above example, an object is bound to the `ngClass`. The object has two properties `red` and `size20`. The property name is assigned to the `div` element as a class name.

Dynamically updating Class names

We can dynamically change the CSS Classes from the component.

Using strings

To do that first create a string variable `cssStringVar` in your component code and assign the class names to it as shown below.

```

cssStringVar: string= 'red size20';

```

You can refer to the `cssStringVar` in your template as shown below

```

<div class="row">
   <div [ngClass]="cssStringVar">Red Text with Size 20px : from component     </div>
</div>

```

Using arrays

Instead of string variable, you can create a **array of string** as shown below.

```

cssArray:string[]=['red','size20'];

```

And, then use it in `ngClass` directive

```

<div class="row">
  <div [ngClass]="cssArray">
    Red Text with Size 20px  : from CSS Array
  </div>
</div>

```

Using JavaScript object

Create a class as shown below in your component

```

class CssClass {
  red: boolean= true;
  size20: boolean= true;
}

```

Next, create the instance of the CssClass in the component as shown below. You can change the value of the property true as false dynamically

```

cssClass: CssClass = new CssClass();

```

And then refer to the cssClass in your template.

```

<div class="row">
  <div [ngClass]="cssClass"> Red Text with Size 20px : from component as object</div>
</div>

```

You can download the source code from GitHub

Summary

We learned how to use the angular NgClass directive, with examples. There are many ways you can style the angular apps, which you can learn from the following tutorials

Further Reading on Angular Styles

- Angular ngStyle
- Style Binding in Angular
- Angular Global Styles
- Angular Component Styles
- View Encapsulation in Angular
- Angular Directives

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